SENATE PROCLAMATION NO. 245

In Memory
of
Roque Vela Sr.

WHEREAS, The Senate of the State of Texas honors the life of Roque Vela Sr., who died July 24, 2026, at the age of 82; and

WHEREAS, Born in Laredo on May 11, 1944, Mr. Vela enlisted in the United States Army at the age of 17; he served abroad in Germany and Vietnam as a squad leader and platoon sergeant with Company B, 3rd Battalion, 60th Infantry, 9th Infantry Division; wounded in combat in 1967, he received the Purple Heart and the Army Commendation Medal for his valor and sacrifice; and

WHEREAS, Following his honorable discharge in 1968, Mr. Vela embarked on a career in business; he transformed Jett Bowling Lanes into a popular enterprise and established entertainment venues in South Texas; his entrepreneurial vision led to a number of successful ventures, including Tasty Burger and the Laredo Lobos arena football team; and

WHEREAS, His business accomplishments were recognized with his designation as the Small Business Administration San Antonio District Minority-Owned Business of the Year and as a Texas Workforce Solutions Employer of Excellence; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Vela contributed to the civic life of his community as a member of the Laredo Independent School District Board of Trustees, Webb County Commissioner, and chair of the City of Laredo Veterans Affairs Committee; and

WHEREAS, Above all, Mr. Vela cherished his family; he married his beloved wife, Cookie, on December 31, 1964, and they were proud parents to their children, Yvonne and Roque Jr., and loving grandparents to their four grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, Roque Vela Sr. led a life of service and leadership that will be remembered with admiration and appreciation by those who knew him; now, therefore, be it

PROCLAIMED, That the Senate of the State of Texas hereby extend sincere condolences to the bereaved family of Roque Vela Sr.; and, be it further

PROCLAIMED, That a copy of this Proclamation be prepared for his family as an expression of deepest sympathy from the Texas Senate.

Zaffirini

_____
Member, Texas Senate

I hereby certify that the above Proclamation was adopted.

_____
Secretary of the Senate